

Draft Manifesto

Cockroach Janta Party

PART 1

The Judiciary

- **Mandate Judicial Appointments to Fill Vacancies:** We demand the immediate filling of all judicial vacancies and an increase in the sanctioned judicial strength to achieve a target ratio of 50 judges per million citizens. We demand the creation of an independent Indian Judicial Service (IJS) to centralize, standardize, and expedite lower judicial appointments.
- **Absolute Ban on Post-Retirement Employment:** We demand a strict constitutional ban prohibiting retired judges of the High Courts and the Supreme Court from accepting appointments in the Executive or Legislative branches, including but not limited to: seats in Parliament (Lok Sabha or Rajya Sabha), seats in the Legislative Assemblies (Vidhan Sabha and Vidhan Parishad), statutory bureaucratic posts, State Governorships, or the offices of the President and Vice-President of India.
- **Abolish the "Master of the Roster" System:** We demand the immediate dismantlement of the "Master of the Roster" system at all levels of the judiciary, which grants Chief Justices and Principal District Judges exclusive discretion over case allocation. It must be replaced by either an automated, randomized, transparent, and open-source case-distribution system OR a collective council of multiple judges.
- **Elevate the Subordinate Judiciary and Establish Courts of Appeal:** We demand a constitutional amendment to elevate the status of District Courts, removing them permanently from the derogatory classification of "subordinate judiciary." Furthermore, we demand the formal establishment of intermediate "Courts of Appeal" dedicated to handling routine appeals arising from the District Courts.
- **Establish a Judicial Accountability Commission:** We demand the creation of independent, statutory Judicial Accountability Commissions at both the national and state levels, empowered to investigate complaints, enforce code-of-conduct compliance, and hold judges across the District Courts, Courts of Appeal, and High Courts fully accountable.

PART 2

Election Commission & Electoral Reforms

- **Amend the Judges (Inquiry) Act and Initiate Impeachment:** We demand an immediate amendment to Section 3(1) of the Judges (Inquiry) Act, 1968, to strip the Presiding Officers of the Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha of absolute discretion to summarily reject impeachment motions. Concurrently, we demand the initiation of formal impeachment proceedings against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar under this reformed framework.
- **Transition to Mixed-Member Proportional Representation (MMP):** We demand the repeal of the First-Past-the-Post (FPTP) voting system. The Constitution and the Representation of the People Act, 1951, must be amended to implement a Mixed-Member Proportional Representation (MMP) system, utilizing either an open-list model or the Baden-Württemberg variation, to ensure the legislature accurately reflects the popular vote.
- **Repeal the 2023 Appointment Act and Equalize Protection for All Election Commissioners:** We demand the immediate repeal of the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, which removed the Chief Justice of India from the selection panel to give the executive an unfair 2:1 majority over the Leader of the Opposition. We demand that either the earlier selection composition be reinstated OR a new, multi-member balanced selection commission be formed. Furthermore, we demand the deletion of the statutory provision allowing the Chief Election Commissioner to unilaterally recommend the dismissal of other Election Commissioners; all Election Commissioners must be granted equal constitutional security and be removable only through formal parliamentary impeachment.
- **Revert to Paper Ballots:** We demand the immediate decommissioning of Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs) and a full return to physical paper ballots OR 100% VVPAT counting, to restore absolute transparency, verifiability, and public trust in the electoral process.

PART 3

Police and Law & Order

- **Enforce the Prakash Singh Directives:** We demand the full, immediate, and faithful implementation of the seven binding directives issued by the Supreme Court of India in *Prakash Singh v. Union of India (2006)* to insulate the police machinery from political interference and secure absolute institutional autonomy.
- **Establish the Right to Record the Police:** We demand that the right of citizens to record police officers executing public duties (in a non-obstructionist manner) be codified as a non-negotiable fundamental right, grounded within the constitutional protections of personal dignity, the right to a fair trial, and the right to information.

PART 4

Media & News Independence

- **Enact Cross-Media Ownership Caps:** We demand antitrust legislation prohibiting any single corporate entity, individual, or conglomerate from holding more than a 10% equity stake or voting share in any news media organization, thereby dismantling corporate monopolies.
- **Establish an Independent Media Regulatory Commission:** We demand the creation of a statutory, financially autonomous Media Regulatory Commission—entirely free from executive control—to oversee journalistic standards and penalize misinformation.
- **Implement a Public News Voucher System:** We demand a state-funded, citizen-directed voucher scheme allowing taxpayers to directly allocate public funds to independent, non-profit news organizations, ensuring financial viability for public-interest journalism. Concurrently, we demand that any financial contributions or public voucher allocations directed toward verified, non-profit news organizations shall be completely exempt from direct and indirect taxation up to a threshold of **[Limit to be determined]**.

PART 5

Education & Social Policy

- **Mandate Constitutional Literacy:** We demand that the Constitution of India be made a compulsory, core subject within the national educational curriculum for all students from primary through higher secondary levels.
- **Implement Universal Menstrual Leave:** We demand the immediate implementation of a mandatory, nationwide policy providing 3 days of menstrual leave per month for women across all government and private schools, colleges, and educational institutions.

PART 6

Parliamentary Procedure

- **Mandate the Appointment of an Opposition Deputy Speaker:** We demand that it be made mandatory to appoint the Deputy Speaker of Parliament and all State Legislative Assemblies. Concurrently, we demand that the post of Deputy Speaker shall be strictly reserved for an elected member of the recognized opposition.
- **Mandate Party Resignation for Speaker and Deputy Speaker:** We demand a Constitutional amendment to mandate that any member elected as the Speaker or Deputy Speaker of the Lok Sabha, or the Speaker or Deputy Speaker of a State Legislative Assembly, shall immediately resign from their political party upon ascending to the Chair. They must maintain absolute political neutrality and be barred from participating in any party activity, political campaign, or executive consultation for their tenure.
- **Establish a Permanent Anti-Defection Tribunal:** We demand an amendment to the Tenth Schedule (Anti-Defection Law) to divest the Speaker of their exclusive adjudicatory power over the disqualification of legislative members. This judicial power must be transferred entirely to either a permanent, independent tribunal OR the Election Commission of India OR a multi-party committee of the respective legislative house.